AgentCon Dallas

Closing Keynote

"Bridging the AI Gap"

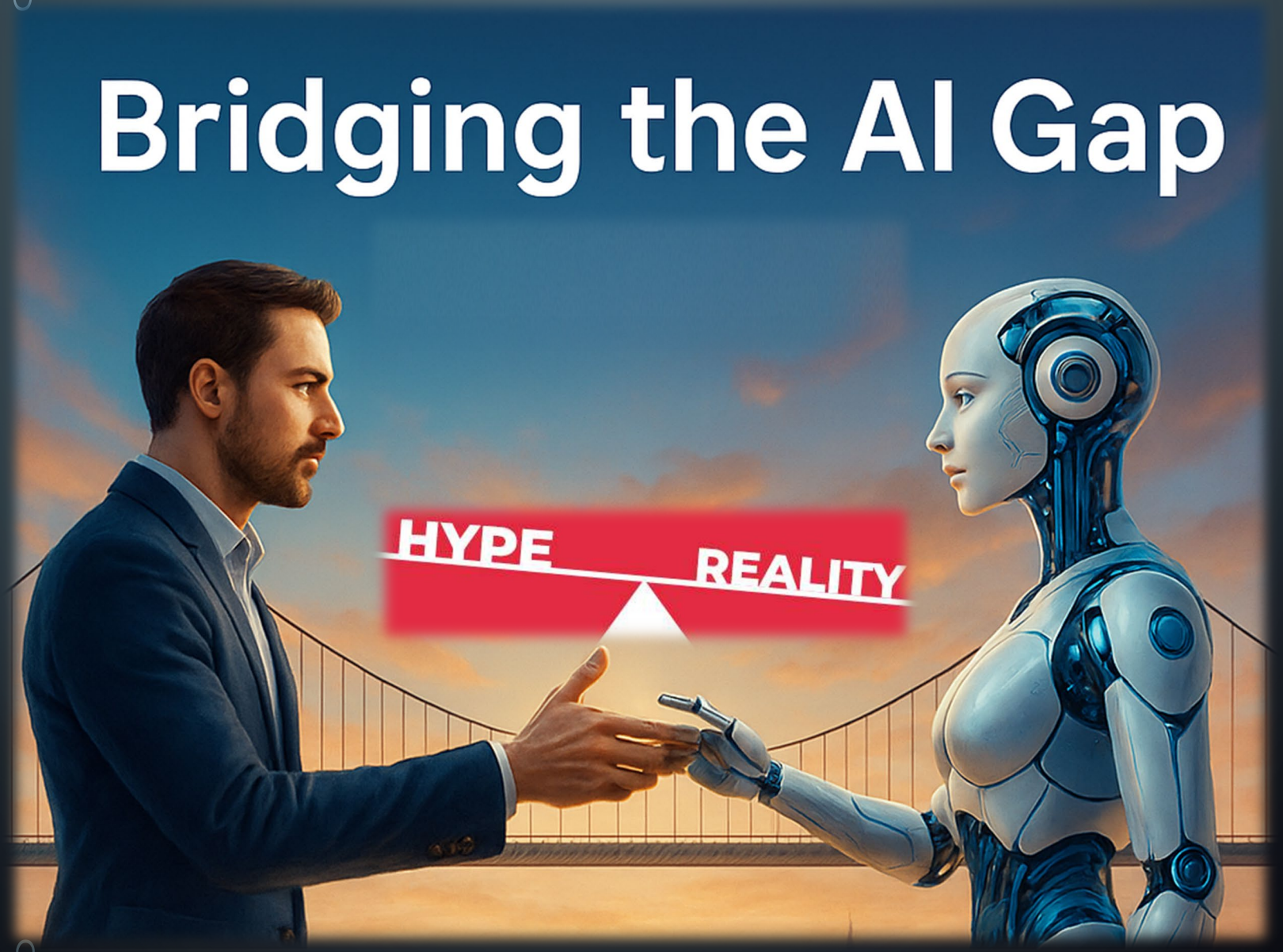


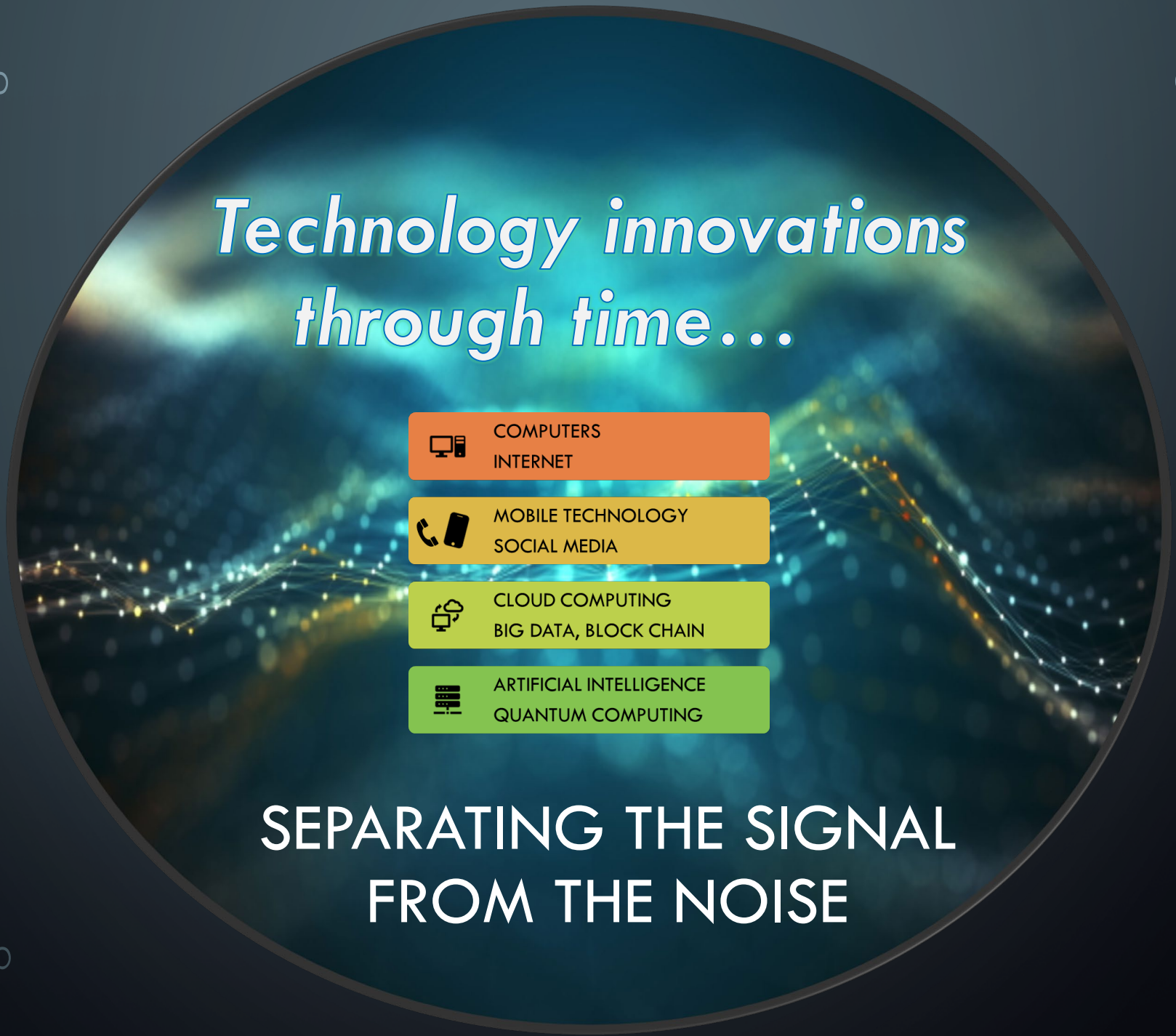
Rebecca (Becky) Caleb

SVP - Global Technology Executive
Bank of America

27 June 2025 - Dallas

Bridging the AI Gap





SEPARATING THE SIGNAL FROM THE NOISE

2025 Statistics

- 2025 Global AI Market ~ Worth $758 Billion
- AI – Top Investment priority for half of tech companies ~ $644 billion, 76.4% increase from 2024
- AI estimated to contribute $15.7 trillion to global economy by 2030 (14% boost)

https://juliety.com/ai-statistics

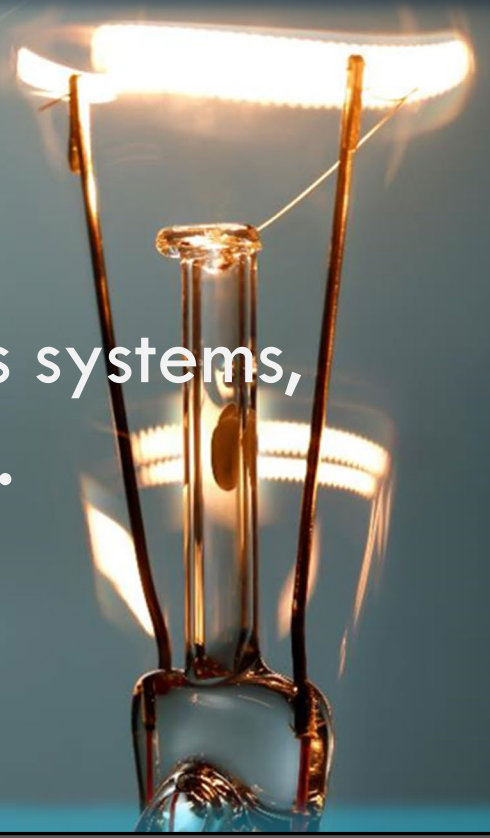
2025 Statistics

- Over 50% companies plan to hire more AI/ML experts

- New AI startups and tools are being launched almost daily, with 3K+ available in 2025

🔬 The AI Moment

- AI Revolution is here
- From ChatGPT to autonomous systems, the AI boom is accelerating…

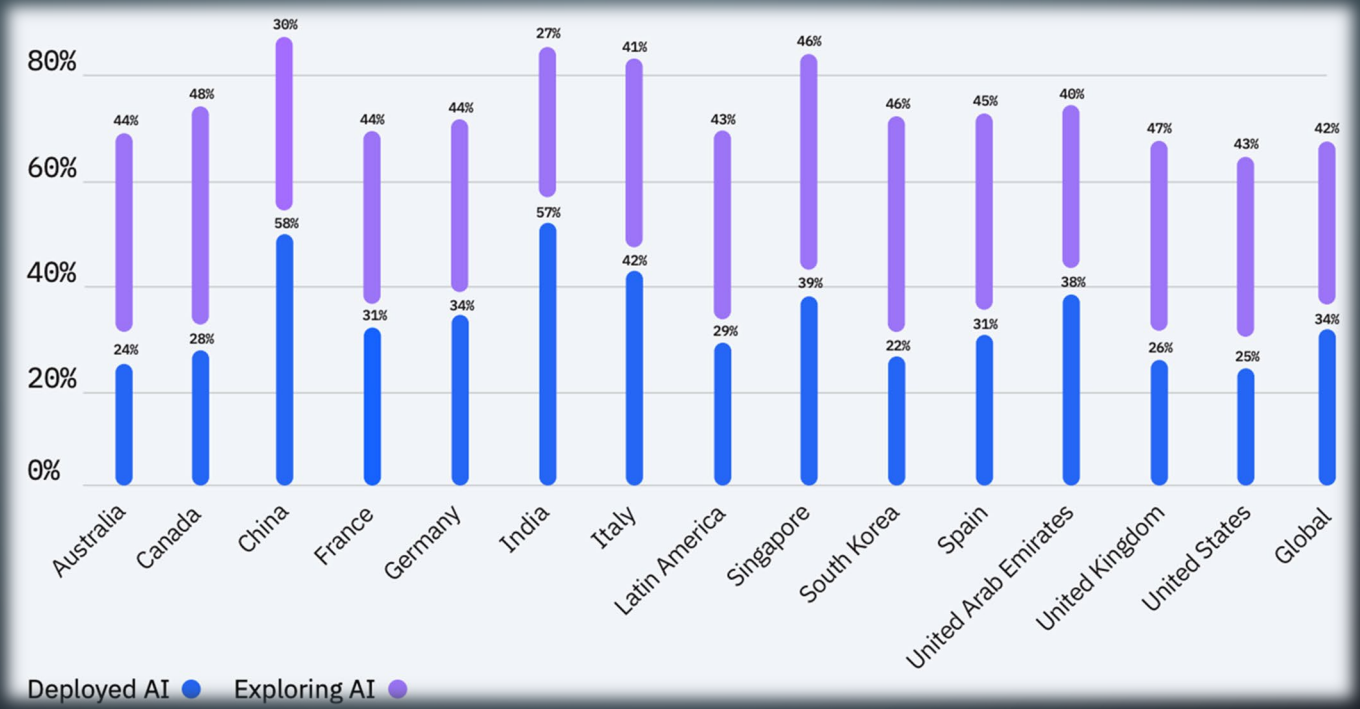


ADOPTION AND IMPACT ARE UNEVEN

AI Exposure & Adoption



Global AI Adoption



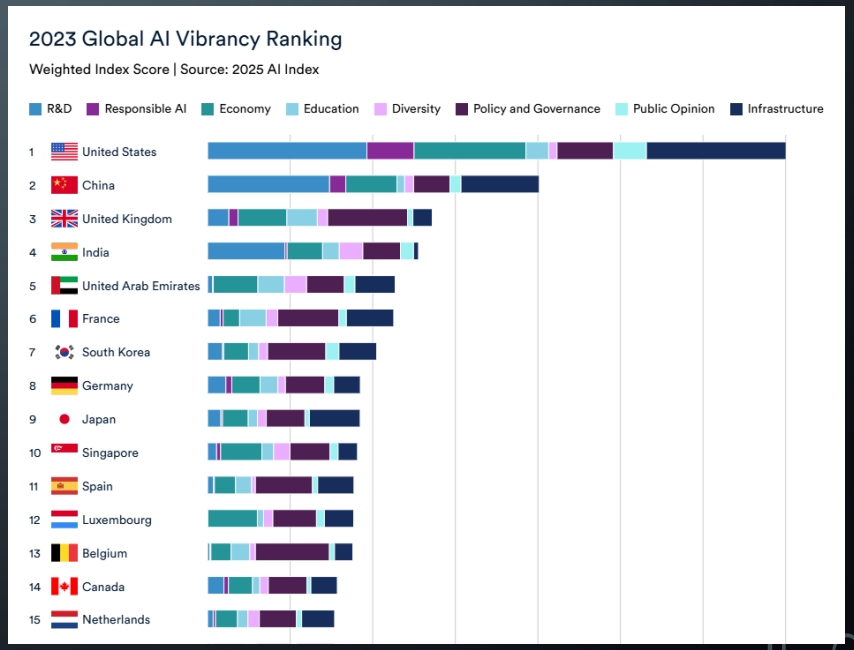
- Skyrocked from 20% in 2017 to 78% in 2024
- Generative AI usage doubling from 33% in 2023 to 71% in 2024

(www.allaboutai.com McKinsey's 2025 Global Survey on AI)

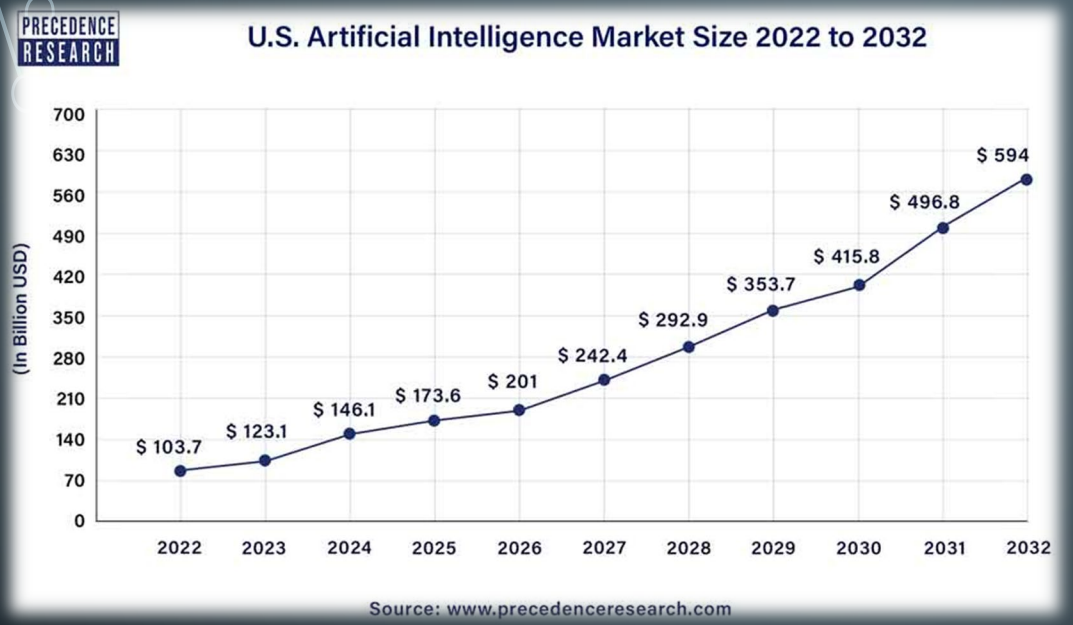
Global AI Vibrancy Tool

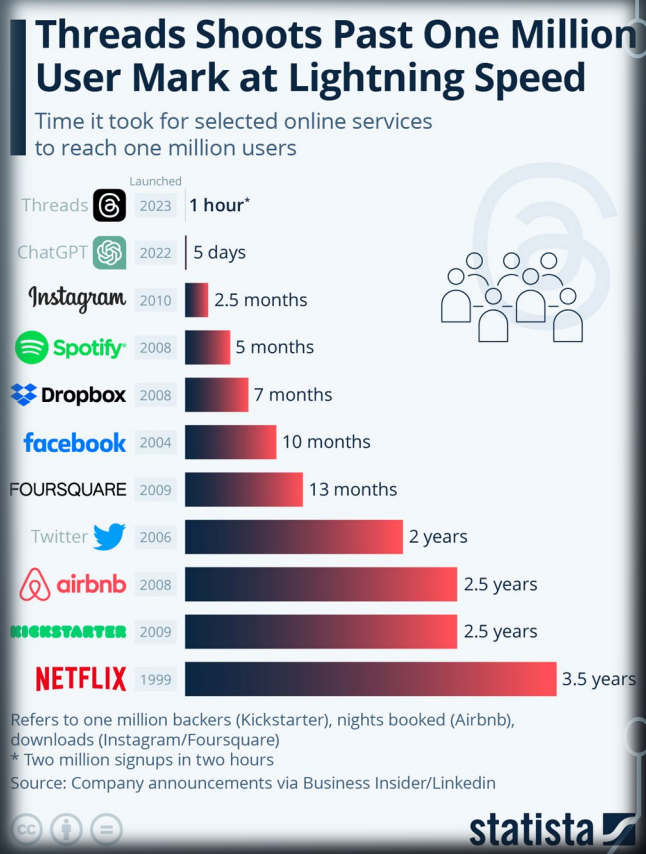
- Developed by Stanford's AI Index
- Tool aggregates 42 AI-Specific indicators across 8 key pillars

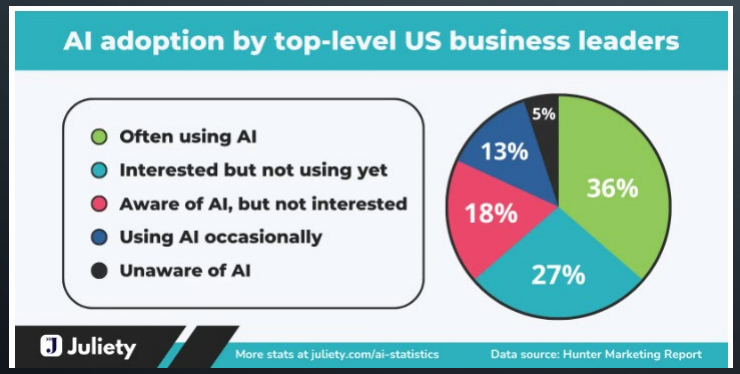




United States - AI Adoption







(www.allaboutai.com, https://team-gpt.com/



WHY DOES THIS MATTER?

Defining the AI Gap

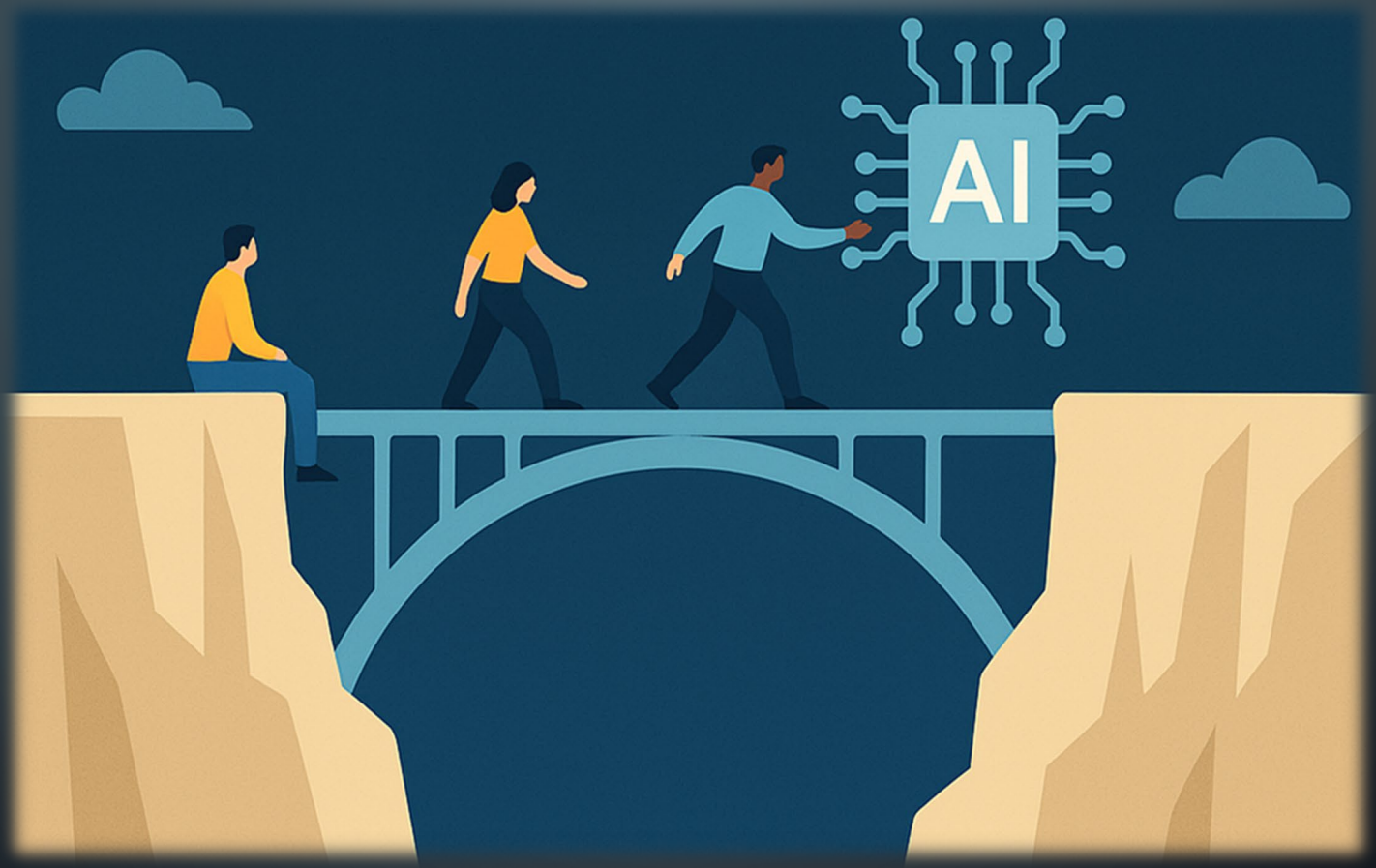
THE AI GAP = THE DISTANCE BETWEEN

AI Potential and Real-world Impact…

- Three critical gaps:
  - Knowledge Gap
  - Execution Gap
  - Trust Gap



AI Knowledge Gap



"Disparity between what people need to know about AI and what they actually know"

AI Knowledge Gap

- Only 20-30% of employees understand how to work with AI
- Lack of AI Literacy
- Fear of automation
- Rapid Evolution of AI Technology

Bridging ~ Knowledge Gap

- AI literacy at all levels
- Upskilling, not just reskilling
- Cross-functional AI fluency – empowering non-technical teams

AI Execution Gap



"The gap between an organization's AI strategy/ ambition and its ability to execute effectively"

AI Execution Gap

- 80% of AI projects stall or fail to scale
- Disconnected Business Strategy
- Limited Data Infrastructure
- Siloed Innovation

Bridging ~ Execution Gap

- Treat AI as a business transformation, not an IT project
- AI needs to be a business strategy, not just a tech experiment.

AI Trust Gap



"The divide between what AI systems can do and how much people trust those systems to do it"

AI Trust Gap

- AI Bias and Fairness
- Job Displacement
- Data Privacy & Misuse
- Transparency and Accountability
- Public Trust is fragile – and essential

Bridging ~ Trust Gap

- Ethical Design
- Clear Governance
- Human-in-the-loop systems

Transition Bridge from Current Strategies to Future Outlook

[redacted] [redacted] [redacted]



Current strategies



Future outlook

Gap Type	Focus Area	Root Cause	Result if unaddressed
Knowledge Gap	Understanding	Lack of education, rapid tech pace	Misuse or underuse of AI
Execution Gap	Implementation	Resource, skills, or process issues	AI strategy fails to materialize
Trust Gap	Adoption	Bias, black-box models, ethics	Stakeholder resistance, slow uptake

Who is falling behind?

- Small & Mid-sized businesses
- Public sector & Academia
- Emerging Markets
- Underrepresented communities

3 Pillar Framework

- People – Broader AI Literacy & Inclusivity
- Process – Scalable, Aligned Deployment
- Principles – Embed Ethics & Responsible Innovation

Call to Action

- Empowerment Through Education
- Tech for Good: Democratizing AI
- Policy & Regulation as Enablers
- Inclusive innovative future we can shape together

The Future is…



"Promote a 'co-pilot' mindset"



"It is a Shared Responsibility"

Thank you!





Rebecca Caleb

Global Technology Executive - Bank of America | Engineering Leader | Board Dire...